College of Europe
Collège d'Europe

Brugge | Natolin

22.06.2024

Farewell address of the Vice-Rector Ewa OŚNIECKA-TAMECKA – Closing of the Academic Year 2023-2024 at the College of Europe in Natolin

Dear Rector Mogherini,
Dear Professors and Colleagues,
Dear Friends of the College - both those who joined us in person and online,
Dear parents and members of families,
and, most importantly, dear students of the College of Europe in Natolin,

Today, we gather to celebrate a big moment, and a joyful occasion that you have been working on for the last 10 months, the graduation of the students of the Madeline Albright Promotion 2023/2024.

I am sure the families and friends of our graduates are sharing the joy. Your unwavering encouragement, love, and care have been instrumental in our students' success.
I extend to you my heartfelt gratitude.

To my colleagues, thank you for your tireless efforts in guiding, mentoring, and inspiring our students. Your passion for education and commitment to excellence brought us to this joyful moment.
Thank you!

Dear Students,
Congratulations!

As I look out at our graduates today, I am filled with great satisfaction.

Your journey to this point has been marked by dedication, resilience, and pursuit of excellence. You have navigated rigorous academic challenges, engaged in vibrant discussions, and immersed yourselves in a rich cultural experience.
Through it all, you have shown a remarkable commitment to understanding and shaping the future of Europe.

I believe your ship is now ready to depart.

Now as this Chapter of your life is ending, a new one is about to begin…
no matter if you are aspiring to serve Europe through Diplomacy, Academia, Public or Private sector,

no matter if you are going to serve Europe in your home country, or beyond, no matter what your specialization is, be honest in expressing your views, and loyal in practicing what you expressed.

Endorse what you believe is truthful and honest no matter how unpopular it is.
Wladyslaw Bartoszewski, the former Polish minister of foreign affairs used to say "It's worth being decent, although it doesn't always pay off. It pays off to be indecent, but it isn't worth it."

Do not fear to bring a different perspective, or to seek change.
It is true that bringing change and swimming against the tide is not easy or safe… a ship is safe in the harbor but that is not what ships are for.
Sail forth with courage, for the world awaits your impact!

Thank you.